

SAP PM SYSTEM STATUSES EXPLAINED

What They Mean and Why They Matter

Introduction

One of the easiest ways to get lost in **SAP PM** is to open a work order and see a stream of automatic status codes like **CNF**, **TECO**, **GMPS**, and **MACM**.

At first glance, they look like system jargon. In reality, each status is a signal telling you exactly where the work order sits in its lifecycle from planning to execution and financial closure.

Understanding these statuses helps planners, supervisors, and maintenance teams immediately identify what has happened and what still needs attention.

Before breaking down individual statuses, there are three fundamental rules every SAP PM learner must know.

1. STANDARD SAP SYSTEM STATUS VS USER STATUS

SAP statuses fall into two distinct categories:

Standard SAP System Status

Delivered out-of-the-box by SAP. They update automatically when specific business transactions are executed.

Examples: CRTD (Created), REL (Released), CNF (Confirmed), TECO (Technically Completed), CLSD (Closed).

Rule: These follow SAP system logic and appear consistently across SAP environments.

User Status

Company-specific statuses configured during implementation to reflect internal business workflows.

Examples: ORAP (Order Approved), OMWC (Order Main Work Completed), WAIT (Waiting for Parts).

Rule: Their meanings vary completely from one organization to another.

Simple Rule: System Status means SAP controls it. User Status means the business defines it.

2. ARE STATUSES MANUALLY ASSIGNED?

Not always. Most standard system statuses are triggered automatically by your physical actions in the system.

Create Work Order → CRTD
Release Work Order → REL
Confirm Labor Hours → CNF
Post Goods Issue (MIGO 261) → GMPS
Technical Completion → TECO

The planner does not manually type these. SAP updates them automatically based on system activity.

User statuses, however, can be manually assigned, workflow-driven, or automatically triggered depending on configuration.

3. DO STATUSES ONLY APPLY TO WORK ORDERS?

No. Both Notifications and Work Orders use statuses, but they track different objects.

Notification Statuses (The Problem)

OSNO (Outstanding Notification)

NOPR (Notification In Process)

NOCO (Notification Completed)

Example: Identifies that “Pump P-101 is leaking.”

Work Order Statuses (The Solution)

CRTD (Created), REL (Released), CNF

(Confirmed), TECO (Technically Completed)

Example: Executes the physical repair to “Replace the seal on Pump P-101.”

THE CORE STATUS CODES

1. CNF (Confirmed)

Status Type: System Status

Meaning: Work execution has been confirmed. The technician has officially recorded labor hours or progress against the work order operations.

Why it matters: It proves labor hours and maintenance activities have been successfully logged.

Important note: CNF does not mean the entire order process is finished. It only confirms execution data has been entered.

2. PRC (Pre-Costed)

Status Type: Configuration-dependent / Costing status

Meaning: Planned costs have been calculated and updated for the order components and labor operations.

Why it matters: It provides management with financial visibility into expected maintenance costs before execution starts.

Why planners care: It allows comparison between planned costs and actual expenditures later.

3. SETC (Settlement Rule Created)

Status Type: System Status

Meaning: A settlement rule has been successfully assigned to the order.

Why it matters: SAP now knows exactly which cost center, asset, or internal order should receive the maintenance costs.

What goes wrong if missing: Settlement errors during month-end closing can prevent cost allocation and leave costs stuck on the order.

4. TECO (Technically Completed)

Status Type: System Status

Meaning: The physical maintenance work is finished, and no further execution or material consumption is expected.

Why it matters: It separates physical execution from financial closure.

What happens when set: Core fields become locked, further changes are restricted, and the order is prepared for final settlement.

Important note: TECO is not CLSD (Closed). An order can be physically complete but still open financially.

5. GMPS (Goods Movement Posted)

Status Type: System Status

Meaning: Materials or spare parts have been issued or received against the work order.

Why it matters: It confirms that inventory has physically moved from stock to the maintenance activity.

Why planners care: It validates that material costs have been posted to the maintenance order.

6. MACM (Material Availability Confirmed)

Status Type: System or configuration dependent status

Meaning: Material availability or reservation confirmation (system-dependent status).

Why it matters: It indicates that required materials have been checked and are available or reserved for execution.

Important note: MACM means availability or reservation, not actual issuance. It typically transitions to GMPS once materials are physically issued.

7. ORAP (Order Approved)

Status Type: User Status

Meaning: The work order has passed internal approval gates.

Why it matters: It ensures maintenance work complies with safety, budget, and governance rules before execution.

Important note: This is a custom configuration and may not exist in all SAP systems.

8. OMWC (Order Main Work Completed)

Status Type: User Status

Meaning: The primary maintenance work is completed, though minor administrative tasks may still remain.

Why it matters: It signals operational completion before final technical or financial closure.

Important note: This status is organisation-specific and depends on system configuration.

Final Summary

An SAP work order status is more than a code. It is the system's way of describing the life of a maintenance activity.

MACM means materials are available or reserved

GMPS means materials are issued and consumed

CNF means work is confirmed

TECO means work is technically completed

SETC means the order is ready for settlement

Key Takeaway: If you can read SAP PM statuses correctly, you can understand the condition of a work order at a glance without opening multiple screens.